PRACTICE PAPER 1 OF 3 · ALL DOMAINS

Practice Paper 1

Eighteen new questions across all eight domains, mixed as on the real exam, with a nine-second hold on each and a scoring guide by domain at the end.

QUESTIONS 18 HOLD 9 s each MODULE 34 of 36

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How to use this paper

- **Commit before the answer plays.** Write down your letter, or both letters for choose-two.
- **Nine seconds is a nudge, not the limit.** Pause whenever you need to think.
- **Each answer slide names the domain,** so you can tally misses by domain.
- **Choose-two:** count it right only if both letters match.
- **The scoring guide at the end** tells you what to rewatch.

> THE HABIT
>
> Watching answers without committing first teaches almost nothing. Pick, then check.

> A claims app sends the same 40-page policy PDF, base64-encoded, in requests from four different features.
>
> Uploads are slow and the payloads are large.

What should the team do?

A. Convert the PDF to page images and send those instead

B. Upload it once with the Files API; reference its ID

C. Paste the PDF's text into each feature's system prompt

D. Split the PDF across several smaller requests

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Convert the PDF to page images and send those instead

Larger, and loses the text layer.

B Upload it once with the Files API; reference its ID

Upload once, reference everywhere.

C Paste the PDF's text into each feature's system prompt

Loses layout; manual copies drift.

D Split the PDF across several smaller requests

Breaks context across calls.

THE SIGNAL

Same file, many requests: upload it once and refer to it by ID.

> A support chatbot sends the same 20,000-token system prompt and tool definitions on every call. Only the user's question changes.
>
> Input tokens dominate the bill.

What should the team do first?

A Move to the smallest model without running evals

B Send every question through the Message Batches API

C Cache the shared prefix of tools and system prompt

D Delete the prompt's examples to cut its length

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do first?

A Move to the smallest model without running evals

A model change without evidence.

B Send every question through the Message Batches API

Users are waiting for replies.

C Cache the shared prefix of tools and system prompt

Repeated prefix, read from cache.

D Delete the prompt's examples to cut its length

Untested quality risk.

THE SIGNAL

A large repeated prefix is exactly what prompt caching discounts.

> An agent researches supplier risk across dozens of sources. Its context fills with raw web pages, and the quality of its final report drops.
>
> The report needs only the key findings from each source.

Which two changes fit best? Choose two.

A Delegate each source to a subagent returning a summary

B Move to a model with the largest context window

C Brief each subagent: objective, format, sources, limits

D Give one agent every tool and a much longer prompt

E Have subagents return full raw pages so nothing is lost

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two changes fit best? Choose two.

A Delegate each source to a subagent returning a summary

Isolates the raw pages.

B Move to a model with the largest context window

More room for the same clutter.

C Brief each subagent: objective, format, sources, limits

Clear briefs, focused work.

D Give one agent every tool and a much longer prompt

The problem, made bigger.

E Have subagents return full raw pages so nothing is lost

Moves the clutter back in.

THE SIGNAL

Isolate the heavy reading in subagents, and brief each one clearly.

> An agent has two tools, search_orders and search_order_items, each with a one-line description.
>
> Traces show it often calls the wrong one.

What should the developer do?

A Fuller descriptions: what each returns, when to use it

B Force the tool choice to the right tool on every call

C Remove one of the two tools from the agent

D Add a system prompt line telling it to pick carefully

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer do?

A Fuller descriptions: what each returns, when to use it

Descriptions drive tool choice.

B Force the tool choice to the right tool on every call

Rejected on current models.

C Remove one of the two tools from the agent

Loses a capability it needs.

D Add a system prompt line telling it to pick carefully

Vague guidance.

THE SIGNAL

Tool descriptions are the biggest lever on tool choice: say what each returns and when to use it.

> A Python service makes 200 independent Claude calls, one after another, for each report. Each call mostly waits on the network.
>
> A user waits on screen for the report. Rate limits have plenty of headroom.

What should the developer do?

A Fire all two hundred calls at once with no limit

B Submit the calls as a batch and return within a day

C Raise max_tokens so each call does more work

D Use the async client with bounded concurrency

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer do?

A Fire all two hundred calls at once with no limit
Spikes into rate limits.

B Submit the calls as a batch and return within a day
The user is waiting.

C Raise max_tokens so each call does more work
Does not reduce waiting.

D Use the async client with bounded concurrency
Parallel, within limits.

THE SIGNAL

Independent, network-bound calls with a user waiting: run them concurrently, with a cap.

> A tool asks questions about a 50-page contract. The prompt puts the question first and the contract after it.
>
> Answers often miss clauses near the end.

What should the developer change first?

A Summarise the contract first and send only the summary

B Contract first, in tags, with the question at the end

C Move to a more capable model for contract questions

D Repeat the question several times in the prompt

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer change first?

A Summarise the contract first and send only the summary

Loses the clauses it needs.

B Contract first, in tags, with the question at the end

Long material first, question last.

C Move to a more capable model for contract questions

Swap the model before fixing the prompt.

D Repeat the question several times in the prompt

Noise, not structure.

THE SIGNAL

Long documents go first, with the question at the end. It is the cheapest fix to try.

> A team wants every engineer's Claude Code sessions to share the same project conventions and allowed commands.
>
> Each engineer also keeps personal preferences.

How should the team set this up?

A Each engineer copies the conventions into user settings

B Commit one shared local settings file to the repository

C Shared files in the repo; preferences in personal settings

D Put everything, preferences included, in managed settings

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the team set this up?

A Each engineer copies the conventions into user settings

Copies drift apart.

B Commit one shared local settings file to the repository

Local settings are personal by design.

C Shared files in the repo; preferences in personal settings

Shared in the repo, personal kept apart.

D Put everything, preferences included, in managed settings

Locks down what should be personal.

THE SIGNAL

Shared means committed to the repository. Personal stays in local or user settings.

> A team is about to launch a Claude feature that drafts replies to insurance claims for agents to edit.
>
> So far it has been tested by its developer on a handful of examples.

Which two belong before a full launch? Choose two.

A Launch to everyone and learn from the complaints that arrive

B An eval set of real claims, with agreed success criteria

C One more round of the developer's own spot checks

D Turn off logging to keep storage costs down

E A flagged rollout with monitoring and a rollback path

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two belong before a full launch? Choose two.

A Launch to everyone and learn from the complaints that arrive

Users become the test suite.

B An eval set of real claims, with agreed success criteria

Evidence of quality.

C One more round of the developer's own spot checks

A vibe check, not evidence.

D Turn off logging to keep storage costs down

Removes the evidence.

E A flagged rollout with monitoring and a rollback path

Small, reversible steps.

THE SIGNAL

Evidence before launch, then a staged, reversible rollout. Two layers again.

A service classifies short support tickets into six categories, about 2 million a month. The target is 95% accuracy.

On the eval set, Haiku 5.5 scores 97% and Sonnet 5.5 scores 98%.

Which model should the team use?

A Haiku, which clears the target at the lowest cost

B Sonnet, for the extra point of accuracy

C Opus, to leave headroom for harder tickets later

D Fable, the most capable model available

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which model should the team use?

A Haiku, which clears the target at the lowest cost
Meets the requirement, cheapest.

B Sonnet, for the extra point of accuracy
Pays for a point nobody asked for.

C Opus, to leave headroom for harder tickets later
No evidence it is needed.

D Fable, the most capable model available
Far beyond the need.

THE SIGNAL

Requirement first: the smallest model that clears the target, measured on your evals.

> A browsing agent reads web pages and can send emails on the user's behalf.
>
> In testing, a page with hidden text told it to email the user's files to an outside address, and it tried.

What is the best defence?

A. A system prompt line telling it to ignore page instructions

B. A move to the most capable model available

C. Block all web browsing for the agent permanently

D. Treat pages as untrusted; gate and scope email sending

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best defence?

A A system prompt line telling it to ignore page instructions

Guidance against an attack.

B A move to the most capable model available

Fewer successes, still possible.

C Block all web browsing for the agent permanently

Permanent avoidance.

D Treat pages as untrusted; gate and scope email sending

Limits what an injection can do.

THE SIGNAL

Indirect injection: assume some will get through, and limit what a hijacked agent can do.

> An agent built on the Claude Agent SDK must never write files outside its workspace folder.
>
> Logs show it occasionally tries to.

What is the best control?

A Add a firmer rule about the folder to the system prompt

B A pre-tool-use hook denying writes outside the folder

C Review the agent's file writes in a weekly report

D Move the agent to a more capable model

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best control?

A Add a firmer rule about the folder to the system prompt

Guidance, which already fails.

B A pre-tool-use hook denying writes outside the folder

Deterministic, before the write.

C Review the agent's file writes in a weekly report

Finds it afterwards.

D Move the agent to a more capable model

Hopes, not enforces.

THE SIGNAL

Must never means code. A hook runs before every write, and can deny it.

> A chat interface waits for Claude's full response before showing anything. Long answers leave users looking at a spinner for ten seconds or more.
>
> Many leave before the answer appears.

What should the team do?

A Move the chat requests to the Message Batches API

B Cap max_tokens so every answer is short

C Stream the response and render text as it arrives

D Open a WebSocket to the Claude API for faster replies

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Move the chat requests to the Message Batches API

Slower still.

B Cap max_tokens so every answer is short

Cuts answers people need.

C Stream the response and render text as it arrives

First words in about a second.

D Open a WebSocket to the Claude API for faster replies

The Claude API has none.

THE SIGNAL

A person waiting means streaming. The Claude API streams with server-sent events.

> An MCP server will give analysts' AI clients access to a reporting database.
>
> Analysts should be able to run read-only queries, and pick from saved report templates in their client's menu.

Which two design choices fit? Choose two.

A Tools for parameterised, read-only queries

B One tool that accepts any SQL, with write access

C Database credentials passed through to each client

D A write tool for every table, in case it is needed

E MCP prompts for the saved report templates

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two design choices fit? Choose two.

A Tools for parameterised, read-only queries

Narrow, model-invoked actions.

B One tool that accepts any SQL, with write access

Far beyond least privilege.

C Database credentials passed through to each client

Credentials should stay server-side.

D A write tool for every table, in case it is needed

Capabilities nobody asked for.

E MCP prompts for the saved report templates

User-chosen templates.

THE SIGNAL

Tools are actions the model calls. Prompts are templates the user chooses.

An agent has 60 tools loaded on every request. The definitions use a large share of the context window.

Traces show tool choice getting worse as tools were added.

What should the developer do?

A Move to a model with a larger context window

B Merge all sixty into one tool with a mode argument

C Tool search, deferring most tools until needed

D Shorten every description to a few words

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer do?

A Move to a model with a larger context window

More room, same confusion.

B Merge all sixty into one tool with a mode argument

One vague tool is worse.

C Tool search, deferring most tools until needed

Load tools when needed.

D Shorten every description to a few words

Removes what guides the choice.

THE SIGNAL

Many tools: keep a few loaded, and let tool search find the rest on demand.

> An editor offers short inline suggestions using Sonnet 5.5 at its default effort.
>
> Quality is more than good enough, but suggestions arrive too slowly to feel useful.

What should the team try first?

A Raise max_tokens so suggestions are never cut off

B Move to Opus for stronger suggestions

C Add retries with shorter timeouts

D Lower the effort level, then re-run the evals

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team try first?

A Raise max_tokens so suggestions are never cut off

Does not speed anything up.

B Move to Opus for stronger suggestions

Slower and costlier.

C Add retries with shorter timeouts

Fails more, not faster.

D Lower the effort level, then re-run the evals

Less thinking, measured.

THE SIGNAL

Quality to spare and latency too high: lower the effort, and confirm with evals.

> Prompts live in a versioned repository. The team wants a new prompt version to reach 5% of traffic first.
>
> If metrics drop, it must be reverted within minutes, without a deploy.

What should the team use?

A. A flag that picks the prompt version by traffic share

B. Edit the production prompt directly and watch metrics

C. Release the new prompt to everyone on Monday morning

D. Keep each prompt version on its own code branch

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team use?

A A flag that picks the prompt version by traffic share

Canary and instant rollback.

B Edit the production prompt directly and watch metrics

No canary, no history.

C Release the new prompt to everyone on Monday morning

Big-bang change.

D Keep each prompt version on its own code branch

Reverting needs a deploy.

THE SIGNAL

A canary plus instant rollback means configuration, not code.

A coding agent works on the same project in sessions days apart.

It keeps re-asking about decisions the team made in earlier sessions.

What should the developer add?

A Keep one single session open for the whole project

B Memory files it writes, then reads at each start

C A model with a larger context window

D Rely on the model to recall earlier sessions

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the developer add?

A Keep one single session open for the whole project

Grows until it degrades.

B Memory files it writes, then reads at each start

Persistent, curated memory.

C A model with a larger context window

Window size is not memory.

D Rely on the model to recall earlier sessions

Models are stateless.

THE SIGNAL

Across sessions, memory lives outside the model: files it writes and reads back.

> A legal research tool answers staff questions from case documents.
>
> Every claim must show the exact supporting passage, and staff must never see a quotation that is not in the source.

Which two belong in the design? Choose two.

A Ask Claude to add page numbers to its prose

B Enable citations on the document blocks

C Verify each cited passage in code before display

D Move to the most capable model available

E Store answers without their sources to save space

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two belong in the design? Choose two.

A Ask Claude to add page numbers to its prose

Unverified, free text.

B Enable citations on the document blocks

Structured, passage-level citations.

C Verify each cited passage in code before display

Code enforces the must-never.

D Move to the most capable model available

Hopes, not checks.

E Store answers without their sources to save space

Removes the evidence.

THE SIGNAL

Citations give the passage. A code check makes the must-never hold.

Answer key, paper 1

QUESTIONS 1-6	QUESTIONS 7-12	QUESTIONS 13-18
1: B (D2)	7: C (D3)	13: A+E (D8)
2: C (D5)	8: B+E (D2)	14: C (D6)
3: A+C (D1)	9: A (D5)	15: D (D5)
4: A (D8)	10: D (D7)	16: A (D2)
5: D (D2)	11: B (D1)	17: B (D1)
6: B (D6)	12: C (D2)	18: B+C (D2)

SCORING

Choose-two items count only when both letters match.

Reading your score by domain

DOMAIN	QUESTIONS	IF YOU MISSED ANY, REWATCH
D2 Applications and Integration	1, 5, 8, 12, 16, 18	Modules 03-04, 09-17
D1 Agents and Workflows	3, 11, 17	Modules 23-26
D5 Model Selection	2, 9, 15	Modules 02, 06, 18-19
D6 Prompt and Context	6, 14	Modules 05, 07-08
D8 Tools and MCPs	4, 13	Modules 20-22
D3 Claude Code	7	Modules 16, 27
D7 Security and Safety	10	Modules 28-29

ON THE EXAM

Where your misses cluster matters more than the total. Rewatch only the weak domain.

After paper 1

- **15 or more right:** strong. Note any domain with a miss, then move on.
- **11 to 14:** close. Rewatch the domain where misses cluster.
- **10 or fewer:** rewatch the weakest two domains before paper 2.
- **For every miss,** name the rule or distractor family that caught you.
- **Leave a day** before paper 2, so it tests recall, not short-term memory.

> SCORING
>
> A rough guide only. The real exam reports a scaled score, with 720 to pass.